

SANSKRIT • FROM DAY ONE

Foundation Reference Charts

Ten compact sheets for sentence roles, IAST, nominative and accusative forms, pronouns, interrogatives, and present verb endings.

Use after retrieval practice-not during the first attempt • every non-English form is supplied in Roman transliteration

PHASE 1 • DESK REFERENCE • 2026

Contents

The PDF bookmarks mirror this table. Lessons are designed to be taken in order; reference sections can be revisited at any time.

Contents	2
1. Sentence blueprint	3
Parsing checklist	3
Core terminology	3
2. Essential IAST	4
Immediate sound changes	4
3. Nominative and accusative a/ā-stems	5
Adjective agreement	5
4. First- and second-person pronouns	6
Common short alternatives	6
5. Third-person tad	7
6. Interrogative kim	8
7. Present parasmaipada	9
Model: paśya- “see”	9
Model stems	9
8. Present ātmanepada	10
Model: labha- “obtain”	10
9. High-frequency present stems and as	11
Present of as “be”	11
10. Error diagnosis	12
One-line production algorithm	12

1. Sentence blueprint

Active sentence

Subject (nominative) + object (accusative) + finite verb agreeing with the subject.

aham tvam paśyāmi - I see you.

tvam mām paśyasi - You see me.

saḥ tām paśyati - He sees her.

Parsing checklist

Order	Question	Result
1	What is the finite verb?	tentative person, number, tense/mood, pada
2	Which form is nominative?	subject in the core active construction
3	Does the verb license a direct object?	look for accusative
4	Do subject and verb coordinates match?	repair person/number mismatch
5	What is the natural English order?	translate from roles, not Sanskrit position

Core terminology

Nominal operation	Verb operation	Agreement
Decline a noun/pronoun for gender, number, case.	Conjugate a verb for person, number, tense/mood, pada.	Active finite verb follows the subject, not the object.

2. Essential IAST

IAST	Working pronunciation	Example
a / ā	short central a / long father-vowel	nara / rāma
i / ī	short / long ee	iti / sītā
u / ū	short / long oo	guru / bhū
ṛ	syllabic r; approximate 'ri' initially	kṛṣṇa
t d n	dental: tongue at upper teeth	tat, deva, nara
ṭ ḍ ṇ	retroflex: tongue curled back	tiṣṭhati, paṇḍita
kh gh etc.	stop + audible aspiration	khādati
ś ṣ s	palatal sh / retroflex sh / dental s	paśya, kṛṣṇa, asti
ṁ	nasal resonance / anusvāra	phalaṁ khādati
ḥ	post-vocalic breath / visarga	rāmaḥ

Immediate sound changes

- -am commonly appears as -aṁ before a following consonant.
- -aḥ can change at a word boundary, e.g. rāmaḥ + atra rāmo 'tra. Learn the underlying form first.

3. Nominative and accusative a/ā-stems

Pattern	Case	Singular	Dual	Plural
masculine rāma-	nom.	rāmaḥ	rāmau	rāmāḥ
	acc.	rāmam	rāmau	rāmān
feminine sītā-	nom.	sītā	sīte	sītāḥ
	acc.	sītām	sīte	sītāḥ
neuter phala-	nom.	phalam	phale	phalāni
	acc.	phalam	phale	phalāni

Neuter rule

Neuter nominative and accusative are identical in every number-not only in a-stems.

Adjective agreement

A regular adjective such as nava- copies gender, number, and case: navaḥ bālāḥ; navaṃ bālam; navā bālā; navāṃ bālām; navaṃ pustakam.

4. First- and second-person pronouns

Paradigm	Role	Singular	Dual	Plural
asmad	nom.	aham	āvām	vayam
	acc.	mām	āvām	asmān
yuṣmad	nom.	tvam	yuvām	yūyam
	acc.	tvām	yuvām	yuṣmān

Common short alternatives

Full accusative	Short form	Meaning
mām	mā	me
tvām	tvā	you (sg.)
āvām	nau	us two
yuvām	vām	you two
asmān	naḥ	us
yuṣmān	vaḥ	you all

Short forms have positional and case-value restrictions. Use full forms for beginning production.

5. Third-person tad

Gender and role	Singular	Dual	Plural
masc. nom.	saḥ	tau	te
masc. acc.	tam	tau	tān
fem. nom.	sā	te	tāḥ
fem. acc.	tām	te	tāḥ
neut. nom./acc.	tat	te	tāni
IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note	
saḥ tām paśyati.	सः तां पश्यति	He sees her.	
sā taṃ paśyati.	सा तं पश्यति	She sees him.	
tau tāni paśyataḥ.	तौ तानपिश्यतः।	Those two men see those things.	
tāḥ taṃ paśyanti.	ताः तं पश्यन्ति	Those women see him.	

6. Interrogative kim

Gender and role	Singular	Dual	Plural
masc. nom.	kaḥ	kau	ke
masc. acc.	kam	kau	kān
fem. nom.	kā	ke	kāḥ
fem. acc.	kām	ke	kāḥ
neut. nom./acc.	kim	ke	kāni
IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note	
kaḥ paśyati?	कः पश्यति	Who sees? masculine subject	
kam paśyasi?	कं पश्यसि	Whom do you see? masculine object	
kim patati?	कपितति	What falls? neuter subject	
kim paśyasi?	कपिश्यसि	What do you see? neuter object	

7. Present parasmaipada

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
3rd	-ti	-taḥ	-anti
2nd	-si	-thaḥ	-tha
1st	-mi	-vaḥ	-maḥ

Model: paśya- “see”

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
3rd	paśyati	paśyataḥ	paśyanti
2nd	paśyasi	paśyathaḥ	paśyatha
1st	paśyāmi	paśyāvaḥ	paśyāmaḥ

Model stems

gaccha- go • vada- speak • paṭha- read • likha- write • khāda- eat • hasa- laugh

8. Present ātmanepada

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
3rd	-te	-ete	-ante
2nd	-se	-ethe	-dhve
1st	-e	-āvahe	-āmahe

Model: labha- “obtain”

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
3rd	labhate	labhete	labhante
2nd	labhase	labhethe	labhadhve
1st	labhe	labhāvahe	labhāmahe

Remember

Ātmanepada is a personal-ending set; it is not identical with passive voice.

9. High-frequency present stems and as

Root	Present stem / form	Meaning	Pada
gam	gaccha-	go	P
ḍṛś	paśya-	see	P
sthā	tiṣṭha-	stand/remain	P
pā	piba-	drink	P
bhū	bhava-	become/be	P
labh	labha-	obtain	Ā

Present of as “be”

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
3rd	asti	staḥ	santi
2nd	asi	sthaḥ	stha
1st	asmi	svaḥ	smāḥ

10. Error diagnosis

Error	Repair rule	Correct form
aham paśyati	first singular subject -mi	aham paśyāmi
tvām paśyasi = “you see”	subject needs nominative	tvam paśyasi
rāmaḥ phalāni khādanti	ignore object for active agreement	rāmaḥ phalāni khādati
rāmau paśyati	dual subject dual verb	rāmau paśyataḥ
“Every -am is object”	neuter nom. = acc.	phalam patati
“ātmanepada = passive”	ending set is not voice identity	saḥ phalam labhate

One-line production algorithm

Choose the subject put it in nominative choose any direct object and put it in accusative conjugate the verb for the subject’s person and number.

Model

“We two see you all.” subject āvām object yuṣmān first dual verb paśyāvaḥ āvām yuṣmān paśyāvaḥ.